

User 2 Empathy Research Interview

- When you have a flare-up, how do you try to "trace back" what caused it?

A: Usually by mentally charting activity, diet, or emotional state over past 24-48 hours and correlate those to symptom start

- What do you find frustrating about your current tracking method, or if you don't track your condition, why?

A: Usually it is executive functioning related if I am unable to track/remember information - cycle of fatigue that causes me to not record data. "Gamification" of data tracking typically works best. If app is too clinical or hard-to-use/boring or glitchy, I won't use it

- What kind of data would you like to log? (e.g., stress, symptoms, meds, sleep, mood, diet, menstrual cycle, illness, exercise)

A: Logging emotional state, food intake, sleep patterns, symptoms, cycle (if it is kept private and not shared to third parties), activity - all these but be able to tie it or flag a flare up to recognize a pattern

- How do you feel about getting reminders to track data?

A: Gentle reminders help

- How do you feel about tracking your Hashimoto Disease? (Anxious, motivated, frustrated, empowered, overwhelmed, etc.)

A: Overwhelmed, disillusioned. It feels like work and I'm not optimistic that it'll actually help because even my doctors can't seem to give me good advice for managing my condition.

- What would help you feel more supported or less isolated?

A: Community, access to reports for data to bring to provider for clear information

- What, if anything, would make it easy to use the app every day?

A: Make it fun, easy-to-use

- What would deter you from using the app?

A: Too much effort - if the data is difficult to input, requires too much mental load, I would move away from use

- How comfortable do you feel storing your health data in an app like this?

A: Uncomfortable - data/user privacy concerns

- If you could tell the person designing this app one thing to make it truly helpful for people with Hashimoto's, what would you say?

A: Make it easy to use, easy to get reports and data to bring to healthcare providers, make it fun to use, ensure privacy - especially for women's health